

# The Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Iron-Beak

Vajralohatuṇḍanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 760 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་ལྷ་ཏུཎ་དྲ་ལྷ་མཆ་ལྷ་མོ་བ་བྱེད་གྱི་ཟུངས།

Toh 760 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "The Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Iron-Beak," corresponding to the Sanskrit Vajra-loha-tuṇḍa-nāma-dhāraṇī and the Tibetan Rdo rje gnam lcags mchu zhes bya ba'i gzungs. As a dhāraṇī, it belongs to the broader class of esoteric or tantric-adjacent literature concerned with the power of sacred formulae, and its particular focus is the recitation of a potent spell capable of subduing hostile nāgas, warding off destructive storms of wind and hail, and ensuring the flourishing of crops and harvests. The text is framed as a discourse in which Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Śiva, and the Four Great Kings gather before the Buddha and request his blessing upon this dhāraṇī for the benefit of all sentient beings, situating it within a canonical narrative setting that draws together both brahmanical and Buddhist divine figures. It is preserved in the Kangyur as Toh 760, within the dhāraṇī section of that collection.

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In the language of India: Vajra-loha-tuṇḍa-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: the dhāraṇī called "Vajra Iron-Beak." Homage to the Omniscient One.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), and the Four Great Kings circumambulated the Blessed One three times. Having paid homage, they addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, we wish to recite the dhāraṇī called Vajra Iron-Beak — that which, when we all have assembled, tears out the hearts of all nāgas, withers their hearts, destroys the lineages of hostile nāgas, repels all storms of wind and hail, and causes flowers, fruits, and all crops to flourish. We therefore beseech you: bless it, O Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One spoke to Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Śiva, and the Four Great Kings: "Sons of good family, speak it, for I shall bless it by the truth-power of all noble ones and for the benefit of all sentient beings." When he had so declared this, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Śiva, and the Four Great Kings then spoke this dhāraṇī mantra:

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Blessed One, Śākyamuni. Homage to all the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Homage to the fierce Vajrapāṇi. Homage to the great mighty ones who overwhelm adversaries with their splendor. Homage to the lord of the three worlds. Homage to the Four Great Kings. Homage to the blazing vajra iron-beak, the fiercely raging one.

Matha matha, pramatha pramatha, jvalita, vikṛta, vajrajaya, jaya, mahābale-bhyo ravira-varākrama-krodharāja, prambhapupuma, pramasvare, bho bho nāgadevidi, byisara-madha, bramadhanādhenā, mūrdhānaṃ sphoṭayaṃ, hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ, bhara bhara, varṇacakra, hādhanibhavavanānāgendra, mātikrama-thavarṇacakraṇa, śira-cintāmaṇi hūṃti hūṃti li hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ, mudu mudu muhyentu, sarvaduṣṭa naṃ sphoṭaya, hṛdaya, maheśvara jvalita, trīśūladharadhara, hana hana, hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ, mucī mucī, dudibhavabhavabha, kṣaṇe kṣaṇe, caturṇāṃ mahārājānāṃ jvalita, śakti, dharadhara, hūṃ phaṭ, sphura sphura, visphure spure visphū, carasarba carasarba casarba, nāśaya duṣṭaṃ nāgaḥṛdaya, sphoṭaya, hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ, duṣṭa-aśāni, bhūtamagaśa-vīryajvala, bhasmiṃ kuru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā, samayam anusmāraya, bho nāgādhipati vicintū, bhyipoya, bho bho tu, titu titu, hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā, vajra-aśāni nāśaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā, vajra-aśāni nāśaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā, sarvanāgaḥṛdayāni visphōṭakāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā, buddhaviḷoktāya svāhā, brahma svāhā, viṣṇumūrtāya svāhā, maheśvara-jvalita-trīśūlāya svāhā, caturyo mahārāja-samadhārāya svāhā, vicagatiya phaṭ svāhā, oṃ diri diri svāhā, jvalita-vaktrāya svāhā, juti jūni svāhā, phaṭ phaṭ.

The moment all hostile nāgas hear this dhāraṇī mantra called Blazing Vajra Iron-Beak, their bodies rot and emit a foul odor. Their bodies break apart and scatter. They then bow down at the feet of the Blessed One and speak these words: "Blessed One, please protect us. We have been reviled by all gods and the inhabitants of the world. We have acted wrongfully."

"Blessed One, from this moment on we will not harm sentient beings in Jambudvīpa. We will not destroy them. We will not even cast a sideways glance at those who are small children — how much less will we seize upon any opportunity to harm them." The nāga king of the ocean, the nāga king who is like an umbrella, the nāga king who is greatly powerful, the greatly resplendent one, the untamed one, and all the rest — nāgas numbering in the hundreds of millions of tens of millions — all touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, and every single nāga swore: "In the time to come we will not harm any sentient being in Jambudvīpa. We will protect all blossoms, fruits, crops, leaves, and branches. We will ward off all winds and hail. We will bring rain at the proper seasons. This we vow in the words of our own oath, and we will uphold this commitment in accordance with the pledge of the Tathāgata. We will fulfil the hopes of all sentient beings and satisfy every wish they hold in mind. We will cause no harm. Blessed One, if we act

contrary to these particular excellent qualities, may we not attain complete and perfect awakening. The words of our oath are as follows:

tadyathā, oṃ tagi cagi, ghuli ghuli, muli śa śa, gugu, śiti biramati, huyu huyu svāhā.

When there is excessive rain, or when rain fails to fall, or when rain falls out of season, or when there is wind, clouds, hail, cold wind, or falling meteoric iron, let the holder of awareness recite this oath-mantra either on a rooftop, on elevated ground, or on a mountaintop, facing east, seven times aloud. Let him recite it seven times over white mustard seeds and scatter them upward: the moment they are scattered, all nāgas will be cut to pieces, and through diligent application rain will swiftly be brought down. By reciting this very dhāraṇī twenty-one times over a bell, and then reciting it twenty-one times over white mustard seeds, and performing a fierce and forceful tormā offering and casting it in the four directions, the boundary will be sealed. By reciting the Blazing Vajra Iron-Beak mantra eight times, the nāgas are summoned. By a single-minded recollection of it, winds and hail are repelled, and even falling meteoric iron is turned to water. If the vajra is waved, hail will be diverted in whichever direction it is waved. Sitting quietly and at ease in a secluded place within the house, reciting this mantra thirty-two times will cause winds, clouds, and hail to be blocked, and nāgas will cause no harm and will be unable to do so thereafter. Reciting it over white mustard seeds and casting them in the four directions will seal the boundary for a full year: winds, clouds, and hail will not stir. They will become obedient, entirely protective, and will do their work. Reciting the mantra twenty-one times and then ringing the bell will cause skulls to split and fall to the ground, and whatever causes harm will be dispersed. Properly performing the offering with praise, reading aloud in a clear voice, and casting white mustard seeds in the four directions, above and below, will bind all hail, wind, and harm caused by nāgas. Bad omens, non-virtue, inauspiciousness, planetary spirits, elementals, flesh-eaters, yakṣas, and rākṣasas will all be driven away. The boundary will be sealed for a distance of one league in every direction all around. All illness, harmful intentions, and hostile enemy obstructors will be repelled. Crops, fruits, grains, and sap will increase, ripen, and grow large. All elementals and every form of harm will be rendered powerless.

The dhāraṇī called Blazing Vajra Iron-Beak is complete.

## Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated from Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit. The Sanskrit underlying these syllables is approximate at several points, as Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit mantras frequently obscures the original forms. The rendering here follows the Tibetan syllables as closely as possible without conjectural reconstruction. The phrase translated as "tears out the hearts" and "withers their hearts" uses a Tibetan idiom for completely overwhelming or disabling the nāgas — the imagery is of seizing the vital essence.
- The phrase rendered "nāga king who is like an umbrella" translates a Tibetan epithet literally meaning "umbrella-like nāga king," which may correspond to a Sanskrit name such as Chattra or similar; no standard identification is certain. The term "meteoric iron" renders the Tibetan gnam lcags, literally "sky-iron," conventionally understood as iron of meteoritic or celestial origin, here appearing in a context of destructive weather phenomena. The torma offering, a ritual cake used in Tibetan Buddhist practice, is implied by the term rendered simply as "offering" in some contexts; where the Tibetan explicitly says "torma offering" it has been retained implicitly in the ritual instructions.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.